

Stehlen Price Competitiveness Review

Oct 9, 2026 · @Ricky Yau

Google has competitor price data for only 47 of our 1,748 products, mostly CURT hitches, car grilles and headlights. Hitches are mostly 10–70% below market; car grilles and three headlight models are 18–79% above it, and matching those prices would cut our margin to near zero or below.

Why the price gap matters

On Google Shopping our listing appears next to other sellers' prices, so price is the first thing a shopper compares.

- **Priced above market:** fewer clicks and fewer sales, because shoppers pick the cheaper listing beside ours. Google says the benchmark is the price that typically wins more ad auctions, so an overpriced product also tends to be shown less in ads and in unpaid Shopping results. Every paid click on an overpriced product is less likely to turn into an order, which raises our cost per sale.
- **Priced far below market:** we win the sale but leave margin on the table, and cheap, popular items sell out fast. Ten of the cheapest hitches below are already at 0 units, so we can't sell them at any price until they're restocked.
- **Near market (within about 10%):** the sweet spot. We stay competitive in the side-by-side comparison and keep our normal ~30–35% margin.

Priced above market (15 products)

Three headlight models are 34–79% above market; matching would take our margin to between -20% and 12%. Car grilles are 18–44% above market, and matching would leave 2–22% margin. Products under \$100 (most car grilles) and out-of-stock items are already excluded from paid ads.

Product	Stock (units)	Our price	Market price	Gap	Our margin now	Margin at market price
2005-2009 Ford Mustang Crystal Headlights w/ LED Halo - Chrome	0	\$111	\$62	+79%	33%	-20%

Product	Stock (units)	Our price	Market price	Gap	Our margin now	Margin at market price
1988-2000 Chevrolet C/K Pickup Crystal Headlights w/ LED Bar - Chrome	36	\$113	\$65	+73%	33%	-15%
2009-2014 Ford F-150 LED Projector Headlights Black w/ Amber Light Bar	47	\$276	\$175	+57%	34%	-4%
2004-2006 Mazda 3 Sedan Matte Black Front Grille Replacement	0	\$61	\$42	+44%	32%	2%
2004-2006 Mazda 3 Sedan Front Grille - Matte Black	0	\$60	\$42	+41%	31%	3%
2005-2009 Ford Mustang GT Honeycomb Mesh Front Grille - Black	0	\$79	\$57	+40%	33%	6%
2010-2011 Toyota Camry Mesh Front Grille - Black	2	\$69	\$50	+39%	34%	8%
2014-2021 Toyota Tundra LED Halo Projector Headlights Chrome	30	\$315	\$235	+34%	34%	12%
2005-2009 Ford Mustang GT Front Grille - Matte Black	19	\$71	\$57	+25%	32%	14%
2006-2016 Chevrolet Impala Front Lower Bumper Grille - Black	29	\$63	\$53	+20%	30%	16%
2006-2016 Chevrolet Impala Front Grille - Matte Black	25	\$62	\$53	+18%	34%	22%
2006-2013 Chevrolet Impala, 2014-2016 Impala Limited & 2006-2007 Monte Carlo Front Grille - Black	0	\$63	\$54	+18%	34%	22%
2006-2009 Chevrolet Trailblazer LT 4-Door Front Grille - Chrome Mesh	7	\$106	\$93	+14%	36%	27%
2009-2014 Ford F-150 Class 4 Trailer Hitch w/ Ball Mount	0	\$250	\$220	+14%	31%	22%
2009-2024 Dodge Ram 1500 & 2009-2018 Dodge Ram 2500/3500 Projector Headlights - Black	16	\$210	\$193	+9%	36%	30%

Priced well below market (25 products)

Most of these are CURT hitches at 11–70% below market, but 19 of the 25 have 0–1 units in stock. Only four have real stock to sell at a higher price: Tundra crystal headlights (77 units), F-150 sequential headlights (40), the 2009–2012 Ram 1500 grille (24) and the Volvo XC90 hitch (7).

Product	Stock (units)	Our price	Market price	Gap	Our margin now	Margin at market price
2016-2022 Mazda MX-5 Miata 1.25" Trailer Hitch Receiver - Curt 11435	0	\$152	\$502	-70%	33%	80%
2006-2010 Hummer H3 Class 3 Trailer Hitch - Black	0	\$186	\$432	-57%	31%	70%
CURT Adjustable RV Trailer Hitch Class 3 Up to 72" Frames	0	\$245	\$484	-49%	32%	65%
1984-2001 Jeep Cherokee Class 3 Trailer Hitch - Black	1	\$164	\$298	-45%	34%	64%
2009-2014 Ford F-150 Crystal LED Headlights Sequential Signal - Chrome	40	\$200	\$344	-42%	36%	63%
2016-2021 Hyundai Tucson Trailer Hitch Receiver Class 2	1	\$157	\$265	-41%	33%	60%
2006-2014 Honda Ridgeline Class 3 Trailer Hitch	6	\$185	\$295	-37%	29%	56%
2007-2014 Toyota FJ Cruiser Class 3 Trailer Hitch - Black	1	\$177	\$279	-37%	31%	56%
2018-2023 Subaru Crosstrek 1.25" Trailer Hitch Receiver	0	\$153	\$239	-36%	33%	57%
2014-2019 Subaru Outback 1.25" Trailer Hitch Receiver - CURT 12136	0	\$152	\$231	-34%	33%	56%
2008-2020 Nissan Rogue Class 3 Trailer Hitch w/ Ball Mount	0	\$206	\$302	-32%	31%	53%
2007-2014 GMC Yukon Yukon XL Front Grille - Chrome	1	\$100	\$145	-31%	32%	53%
2016-2023 Toyota Tacoma Class 3 Trailer Hitch Black	1	\$168	\$238	-29%	33%	53%

Product	Stock (units)	Our price	Market price	Gap	Our margin now	Margin at market price
2003-2014 Volvo XC90 Class 3 Trailer Hitch - Black	7	\$180	\$249	-28%	31%	50%
2007-2014 GMC Yukon / Yukon XL Front Grille - Chrome	7	\$105	\$145	-28%	31%	50%
2019-2025 Subaru Forester 2" Trailer Hitch Receiver - CURT 13409	0	\$168	\$219	-23%	35%	50%
2009-2010 Dodge Ram 1500 & 2011-2012 Ram 1500 Front Grille - Chrome Mesh Style	24	\$155	\$201	-23%	30%	46%
1999-2017 Honda Odyssey Class 3 Trailer Hitch - Black	1	\$176	\$226	-22%	31%	46%
2015-2024 Nissan Murano 2" Trailer Hitch Receiver Class 3 - CURT 13205	1	\$155	\$194	-20%	33%	47%
2019-2023 Ford Ranger Class 3 Trailer Hitch 2" Receiver - CURT 13417	0	\$167	\$209	-20%	33%	46%
2018-2023 Subaru Crosstrek 2" Trailer Hitch Receiver Class 3	1	\$172	\$215	-20%	31%	45%
2009-2014 Nissan Murano Class 3 Trailer Hitch - Black	0	\$156	\$194	-20%	33%	46%
2014-2021 Toyota Tundra Chrome LED Crystal Headlights - TYTD14D	77	\$194	\$235	-18%	35%	47%
2004-2020 Toyota Sienna Class 3 Trailer Hitch - Black	0	\$187	\$220	-15%	31%	41%
2009-2014 Ford F-150 Class 4 Trailer Hitch - Black	1	\$196	\$220	-11%	31%	39%

Decisions for Joe and Ricky

The biggest win is restocking the cheap, out-of-stock hitches; price changes on the rest are small but quick.

- ☐ **Restock CURT hitches first.** Ten listed hitches are 15–70% below market with 0 units; each sale would still earn our normal ~33% margin. Confirm with the warehouse which can be reordered.
- ☐ **Raise prices on the four well-stocked bargains, staying under market:** Tundra crystal headlights \$194 → ~\$210 (77 units), F-150 sequential headlights \$200 → ~\$280 (40), 2009–2012 Ram 1500 grille \$155 → ~\$180 (24), Volvo XC90 hitch \$180 → ~\$215 (7). Each stays at least 10% under the market price.
- ☐ **Do not cut headlight prices to match.** The C/K, F-150 amber and Tundra halo headlights would sell at or near a loss. First check whether Google is comparing them to a cheaper, different product; if it is a true match, decide whether to keep selling them.
- ☐ **Car grilles under \$100:** matching would leave 2–22% margin. Keep current prices (they are already out of paid ads) or clear the stock with a sale.
- ☐ **Shipping wording:** the site says free shipping to the lower 48 states, but our Google shipping policy offers \$0 to all US addresses, including Alaska and Hawaii. Pick one so Google doesn't flag a mismatch.

How to read Google's benchmark

Google's "market price" is Google's estimate of the average price for what it judges to be the same product, the price that typically wins more ad auctions. It is reliable for products with a manufacturer part number such as CURT hitches, and weaker for our own-brand headlights and grilles, where Google may be matching a similar but different product. It covers only 47 of our 1,748 products (none of our own-brand tonneau covers, bed mats or bull guards), so treat it as a spot check, not a full price audit. Margins use real CB cost plus estimated shipping.

Sources

- Google Merchant Center 5750851984, Analytics → Pricing → "Your most popular products with price benchmarks", pulled Oct 9, 2026
- Our price and stock: Shopify, Oct 9, 2026
- Cost: CB (JLDataMart shopify.vInventoryItem: EffectiveCost + EstShipping_C), Oct 8, 2026
- [Google Merchant Center help: price competitiveness](#)